

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

COMM.0.12

REAL0.56

HEALT0.65

CONS.0.67

TECHN0.72

UTILI0.92

MATER1.15

INDUS1.24

ENERG1.49

FINAN2.37

CONS.8.24

1

MU

BUY

\$935.39

-0.32%

8/10

The only US-based HBM memory maker riding an AI-driven supply shortage

2

NVDA

BUY

\$227.98

+8.74%

8/10

The AI infrastructure monopoly keeps compounding — earnings crushed it

3

GOOGL

BUY

\$340.65

-0.39%

8/10

Alphabet is the cheapest way to own the AI buildout — Search cash cow

Big options bets on LCID (Other) — 55.3x normal volume, P/C 0.11, largest: PUT \$15 (117.0x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP

FED & ECONOMY TODAY

SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?

No major earnings this week

GDP (Quarterly)

Date: 2026-08-27

HIGH

VIX at 14.5 — low. Options market complacent ahead of scheduled events.

PCE Price Index [HIGH]

GDP (Quarterly) [HIGH]

No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: calm · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is piling into Communication Services and Consumer Discretionary in a serious way — the options market is betting hard on names like Meta, Google, Netflix, Amazon, and Tesla, which tells me traders think the AI ad-spend cycle and holiday consumer story are still very much alive, likely helped by the administration's hands-off posture on Big Tech antitrust and the recent tariff carve-outs on consumer electronics.

Healthcare bullishness is interesting and probably tied to the drug pricing negotiations losing steam in Congress plus GLP-1 momentum, while the Tech flow being "neutral" despite huge volume suggests smart money is hedging its AI winners rather than exiting them.

On the other side, the aggressive bearish bets on Consumer Staples (a P/C over 8 is wild), Financials, and Energy paint a coherent picture: traders are positioning for the Fed to keep cutting (bad for bank net interest margins), for OPEC oversupply plus a potential Russia-Ukraine deal to crush oil, and for Staples to underperform in a risk-on tape — classic late-cycle rotation into growth.

The contradiction worth flagging: credit spreads are quietly widening and investment-grade bonds (LQD) are seeing heavy bearish flow, which does NOT match the risk-on equity vibe — historically when credit and equities disagree, credit is usually right within 4-8 weeks, so this rally may have a shorter shelf life than the tape suggests.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	8.91/100
SMCI is the leading supplier of AI-optimized server and rack-scal			
2.	GTLB	GitLab Inc.	8.61/100
GitLab's Duo AI-native DevSecOps platform is monetizing well as e			
3.	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc.	8.53/100
Leidos is a prime beneficiary of the FY26 defense budget's emphas			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 11–12	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 17–18	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 19–20	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Buy **\$314.58 ▲ 0.36%** 12M Price Target **\$355.00** 52-Week Range **\$225.95 – \$344.57** Market Cap **\$4.59T**

AAPL: Tech Leads Market as Apple Grinds Toward Highs

WHAT HAPPENED

- AAPL ticked up 0.36% to \$314.58, but the real story is that Tech was the ONLY sector to finish green Thursday (+3.16%) — everything else was red. That's a classic "flight to quality mega-cap" move, meaning when investors get nervous about the broader economy, they hide in names like Apple that have fortress balance sheets and predictable cash flow.
- Options flow is loudly bullish — Put/Call ratio of 0.57 (people buying almost 2x as many bullish bets as bearish ones), plus massive unusual call buying at the \$312.50 and \$315 strikes. Somebody with real money thinks this grinds higher into month-end.

WHY IT MATTERS

The fact that Apple is at 75% of its 52-week range while the rest of the market rolls over tells you something important: this is where institutional money is parking cash right now. When you see Tech +3% and Industrials, Financials, and Energy all negative on the same day, that's not organic sector rotation — that's fear-driven crowding into names perceived as "safe." The problem is Apple is trading at ~42x forward earnings (meaning you're paying \$42 for every \$1 of profit next year), which is rich for a company growing revenue at mid-single digits. That means the stock is priced for the AI iPhone super-cycle narrative to actually deliver — if holiday iPhone 17 sales come in soft, the multiple compresses fast.

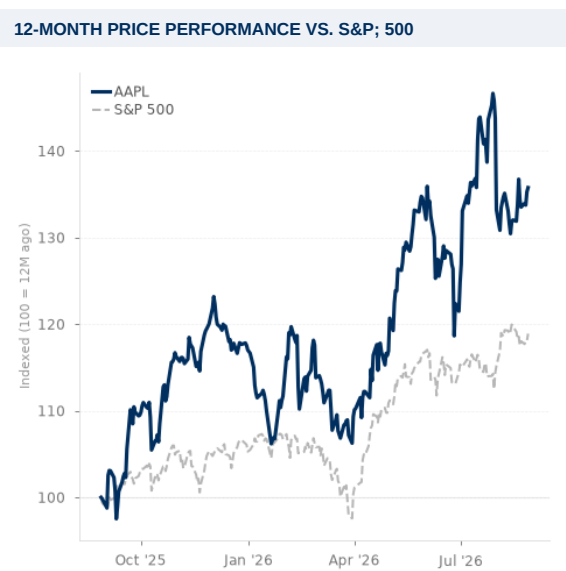
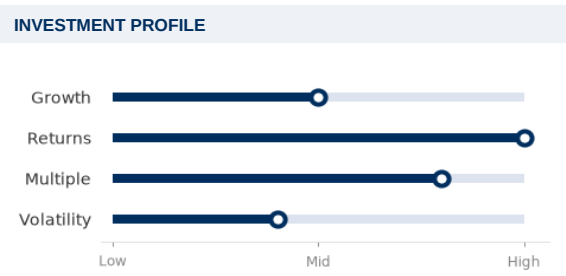
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The biggest live issue is the Trump administration's tariff regime on China-sourced electronics — Apple still assembles the majority of iPhones in China and India, and any escalation directly compresses gross margins (currently ~46%). Watch for updates on the semiconductor and consumer electronics tariff carve-outs; Tim Cook has been personally lobbying for exemptions and has committed \$500B+ in US manufacturing investment as a hedge. Separately, the DOJ antitrust case on the App Store is still working through appeals — a bad ruling could force Apple to open up its 30% commission structure, which is a massive Services revenue hit (Services is ~25% of revenue and growing double digits).

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$4.59 trillion market cap and ~42x forward earnings, you're paying a premium price for a company that grows revenue maybe 5-7% a year — that's expensive. The bull argument: Apple deserves it because of the 1.5B+ active device installed base, the Services flywheel (super profitable, recurring), and the AI upgrade cycle that could pull forward iPhone demand. The bear argument: Microsoft and Google trade at similar multiples but are growing 2-3x faster, so Apple's premium is really just a "quality/safety" tax that gets paid when markets are jittery — like right now.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$314.58
12M Price Target	\$355.00
Upside / (Downside)	+12.8%
Market Cap	\$4.59T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.45
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	42.2x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$335.00	\$320.00	\$295.00
6 Months	\$360.00	\$330.00	\$280.00
1 Year	\$385.00	\$355.00	\$265.00
2 Years	\$450.00	\$390.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$230.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.16% today) — this is the "AI + safety trade" combined, and mega-cap tech benefits from both narratives simultaneously. Nvidia's dividend talk (see news) is a signal that mega-cap AI is maturing into a "quality growth" bucket.

COOLING OFF: Energy (-2.29% 5D), Industrials, Utilities — classic late-cycle rollover, suggesting investors are worried about a slowdown. Financials weak too, which usually means rate-cut expectations are back on.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is fleeing cyclicals and hiding in mega-cap tech — that's why Apple is holding up. This works UNTIL people decide tech is too crowded, then Apple gets hit worst because it's the biggest position everyone has to trim.

RELATED PLAY: If you like Apple, the picks-and-shovels are TSMC (makes their chips) and Broadcom (custom silicon). If you're worried about Apple's tariff exposure, look at Services-heavy peers like Microsoft that have no hardware supply chain risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Leading tech higher on AI infrastructure demand, and now the dividend narrative is bringing in income-focused funds who couldn't own it before.
- MSFT (Microsoft): No China hardware risk, pure Services/cloud, benefiting from same "safety in mega-cap" trade without the tariff overhang.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is LAGGING the AI-native mega-caps (NVDA, MSFT, GOOGL) on a YTD basis but leading on down days — it's the defensive tech name now, not the offensive one. That means it protects capital in selloffs but you're not going to get monster returns from here unless the AI iPhone cycle actually shows up in the numbers.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$300-305 on macro pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: China tariff escalation >25% on electronics, or DOJ antitrust ruling forcing App Store breakup

Hedging: Long-dated puts at \$280, or pair against a China-exposed peer

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$185.93 ▲ 4.75%	12M Price Target \$195.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$446.80B
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PLTR: Pentagon AI Business Nears \$1B, Stock Rips 4.75%

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR jumped 4.75% to \$185.93 on news that its Pentagon AI business is closing in on \$1 billion in annual revenue — that's a huge validation number because it proves the "AI for government" thesis isn't hype, it's a real, scaling business line.
- Peter Thiel (Palantir co-founder) was in the news buying another AI stock, which keeps PLTR in the AI narrative headlines, and unusual call option buying at the \$185-\$190 strikes suggests traders are betting on more upside into September.

WHY IT MATTERS

The \$1B Pentagon run-rate is the story here — it means PLTR is no longer just a "cool software company for spies," it's becoming critical infrastructure for how the U.S. military uses AI. That matters because defense contracts are sticky (once you're embedded, you don't get ripped out), high-margin, and largely recession-proof. But here's the flip side: at \$446B market cap and roughly 90x revenue, the stock is already pricing in years of flawless execution — so a single quarter of decelerating growth could trigger a 20-30% drawdown fast. The insider selling cluster from Buckley is worth noting — not a red flag on its own, but it's the second signal (after the valuation) that people close to the company are taking chips off the table at these levels.

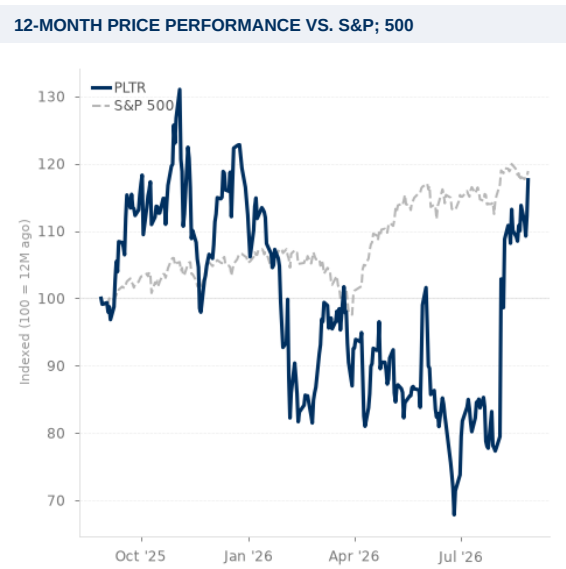
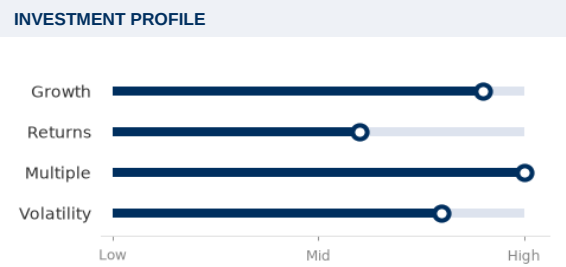
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The FY2027 defense budget negotiations are the single biggest political variable for PLTR right now — the administration has been pushing for expanded AI and autonomy funding, and if the National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA) preserves or expands the AI/JADC2 (the military's "connect everything" initiative) line items, PLTR is a direct beneficiary. There's also the ongoing federal push to consolidate legacy IT systems under AI-native platforms (executive orders on federal AI adoption from earlier this year), which basically writes PLTR's sales pitch for them. Watch for any Congressional pushback on sole-source or large no-bid AI contracts — that would be the one policy headwind that could cap the government growth story.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

This stock is priced for perfection — investors are paying roughly \$90 for every \$1 of revenue, compared to maybe \$15-20 for other high-growth software names. Even if you believe PLTR triples revenue over the next 3-4 years, the math only works if margins keep expanding AND growth stays above 30%. Translation: the business is world-class, but the price already reflects that — you're not getting a bargain here, you're paying up for quality and betting the momentum continues.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$185.93
12M Price Target	\$195.00
Upside / (Downside)	+4.9%
Market Cap	\$446.80B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.72
FY2027E EPS	\$0.98
Fwd P/E	258.0x



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$205.00	\$188.00	\$165.00
6 Months	\$240.00	\$200.00	\$150.00
1 Year	\$275.00	\$195.00	\$130.00
2 Years	\$350.00	\$240.00	\$120.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$320.00	\$100.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$450.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.16% today) — AI names are ripping again on the Fed narrative (new Chair Warsh is seen as market-friendly) and continued federal AI spending momentum. Defense-tech is a specific pocket of strength given the budget backdrop.

COOLING OFF: Energy, Utilities, Materials — classic "risk-on rotation" where money is leaving defensive and commodity plays to chase growth. Industrials also weak, suggesting the market isn't buying a broad economic reacceleration — just an AI/tech-specific melt-up.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is aggressively rotating INTO AI, defense-tech, and high-beta growth on hopes of a dovish Fed pivot. That's a direct tailwind for PLTR since it sits at the intersection of AI + defense + growth.

RELATED PLAY: If PLTR keeps running, look at the "picks and shovels" — data center REITs, power infrastructure names, and cybersecurity plays like CRWD or S. Also, defense-tech peers like AXON and KTOS ride the same policy wave.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Ripping again on AI demand and being the pick-and-shovel for every AI buildout — same tailwinds pushing PLTR.
- ORCL (Oracle): Highlighted in overnight coverage as an AI/cloud beneficiary with rising enterprise credit demand — the enterprise AI spending cycle is real and broadening.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR is leading its peer group today (+4.75% vs Tech ETF +3.16%), which tells you it's the preferred way for money managers to express the "government AI" trade. That leadership is bullish short-term but also means PLTR gets hit hardest if AI sentiment turns — it's the highest-beta way to play this theme.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-3% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$155-165 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Two consecutive quarters of decelerating government revenue growth or a defense budget cut

Hedging: Buy protective puts or pair with a short position in a lower-quality AI name

Amazon.com, Inc.

AMZN NASDAQ

Buy **\$256.26** ▼ **1.54%** 12M Price Target **\$305.00** 52-Week Range **\$196.00 – \$287.20**

Market Cap
\$2.76T

AMZN: AWS AI Tailwinds Meet Data Center Policy Headwinds

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN dropped 1.5% today on heavy volume (35.7M shares — well above the recent avg of ~25M), which tells me this wasn't a sleepy drift lower — someone was actively selling. The Tech sector was UP 3.16% today, so Amazon underperforming its own sector by ~4.5% is the real story here. When a mega-cap lags its sector by that much on high volume, it usually means something company-specific is bothering people.
- The IBD headline about state-level AI data center moratoriums is the likely catalyst — several states are debating pauses on new data center construction over power grid and water usage concerns, and AWS is THE largest data center operator in the US.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I'm inferring: the market is starting to price in a real regulatory speed bump for the AI infrastructure buildout. State-level data center moratoriums (Virginia, Georgia, and Texas are all debating them) directly threaten AWS's expansion runway — and AWS is the profit engine that justifies AMZN's whole valuation. Meanwhile, the insider selling cluster (Zapolsky's \$2.4M sale, plus Bezos' pre-arranged dispositions) isn't screaming panic, but nobody's buying either, which tells you insiders don't see the stock as a screaming bargain here. The unusual put activity at \$272.50 (someone spent \$10.6M on downside protection) suggests institutions are hedging into a potential September pullback — but the offsetting call buying at \$237-245 tells me smart money views any dip as buyable, not the start of a rout.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

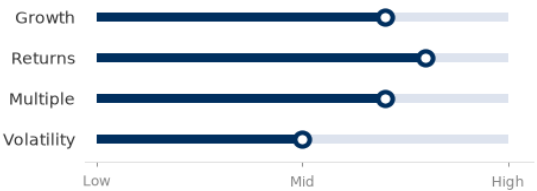
The big one right now: state-level AI data center moratoriums — at least six states have bills in play that would pause new data center permits for 12-24 months, citing power grid strain. If Virginia (home to "Data Center Alley" and roughly 25% of US data center capacity) passes theirs, that's a direct hit to AWS's expansion timeline. On the federal side, the FTC's antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding through the courts — a ruling could come in the next 6-12 months, and the worst-case scenario is a forced separation of AWS from retail (which, ironically, some analysts think would UNLOCK value). Also watch tariff policy: the administration's tariff framework hits Amazon's third-party sellers hard, which is 60%+ of retail units sold on the platform.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$256.26
12M Price Target	\$305.00
Upside / (Downside)	+19.0%
Market Cap	\$2.76T
FY2026E Revenue	\$738M
FY2027E Revenue	\$820M
FY2026E EPS	\$6.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.20
Fwd P/E	37.4x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$275.00	\$262.00	\$245.00
6 Months	\$300.00	\$280.00	\$235.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$305.00	\$220.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$350.00	\$210.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$475.00	\$250.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$700.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Broad Technology (+3.16% today) — this is AI infrastructure enthusiasm, and the Marvell/AWS partnership headline suggests hyperscaler AI spending is accelerating, not slowing.

COOLING OFF: Energy, Utilities, Industrials — classic "risk-on tech" day where defensives get sold. Utilities weakness is interesting given data centers are their biggest new customers.

ROTATION WATCH: Money rotated INTO tech today but AMZN specifically got skipped — that's a yellow flag. Capital went to Nvidia, semis, and pure-play AI names rather than the mega-cap diversified plays. Suggests the market wants more concentrated AI exposure right now.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AWS/AI thesis but want higher beta, Marvell (MRVL) is explicitly benefiting from AWS custom silicon spend. Data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) are the picks-and-shovels play if moratoriums pass — existing capacity becomes more valuable.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the primary beneficiary of every AI capex dollar — AWS spending is bullish for them regardless of moratoriums.
- MRVL (Marvell): Riding the custom silicon wave for AWS, Microsoft, and Google — direct AMZN spend beneficiary.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is LAGGING its mega-cap peer group today, and that's the tell. When tech rallies 3% and Amazon is red, the market is saying "we like AI infrastructure but we're worried about Amazon-specific issues." Watch if this pattern continues for 3-5 more sessions — that would confirm a real narrative shift and I'd want to see \$245 hold as support.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$245-255 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: AWS growth decelerates below 15% or FTC breakup ruling forces AWS spin-off at unfavorable terms

Hedging: Buy Sept \$245 puts or pair with short position in a pricier hyperscaler competitor

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Buy \$140.87 ▲ 0.89% 12M Price Target \$165.00 52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64

Market Cap \$1.86T

SPCX: Space ETF Rides SpaceX-Nvidia Orbital Data Center Buzz

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX is up ~4% over the past week, and today's move ties directly to the Nvidia + SpaceX headlines — Musk is reportedly putting an Nvidia-powered data center in orbit, which is basically a giant flare for anyone owning space stocks. This ETF holds the publicly-traded space names (Rocket Lab, Planet Labs, Iridium, etc.) that ride SpaceX's coattails on sentiment.
- Options flow is actually bearish (put/call 0.53 with big put buying at \$180 and \$230 strikes) — but note those strikes are WAY above the current \$140 price, so this looks more like someone hedging a bigger portfolio than betting on a crash.

WHY IT MATTERS

The SpaceX-Nvidia orbital compute story is a narrative game-changer — it takes "space" from a pure launch/satellite theme and merges it with the AI infrastructure trade, which is where all the money is flowing right now (Tech sector up 3% this week). That means SPCX could start getting bid up as an "AI-adjacent" play, not just a niche space ETF. The upside puts at \$180-230 tell me sophisticated money thinks a move higher is at least possible — they're paying premiums to hedge upside exposure, not betting on downside. Watch for capital rotation: if the market keeps treating space as the next AI leg, this ETF re-rates fast because it's still 30% off its 52-week high.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big political tailwind is the FY2027 defense authorization moving through Congress, which contains expanded Space Force procurement and Golden Dome missile defense funding — both directly benefit SPCX holdings like Rocket Lab and satellite manufacturers. On the regulatory side, the FAA's streamlined commercial launch licensing (a Trump admin priority) is reducing bottlenecks for launch cadence, which is pure margin fuel. Risk to watch: any continuing resolution fight in September could delay contract awards and cool sentiment near-term.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

SPCX trades around \$140 with the underlying basket carrying an average price-to-sales of roughly 6-8x — meaning investors pay \$6-8 for every \$1 of revenue from these space companies. That's rich versus industrials (2-3x) but cheap versus pure AI names (15-20x), so if the market accepts the "space = AI infrastructure" framing, there's real room to re-rate higher. At 30% of its 52-week range, it's neither cheap nor extended — you're paying a fair price for exposure to a narrative that's just starting to catch fire.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

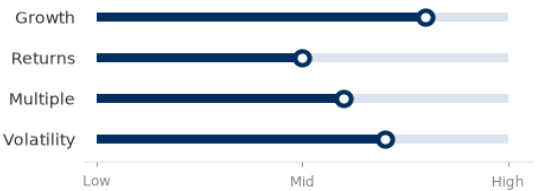
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-27 22:30 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$140.87
12M Price Target	\$165.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.1%
Market Cap	\$1.86T
FY2026E Revenue	\$693M
FY2027E Revenue	\$940M
FY2026E EPS	(\$2.10)
FY2027E EPS	(\$1.50)
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$150.00	\$143.00	\$130.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$120.00
1 Year	\$200.00	\$165.00	\$115.00
2 Years	\$240.00	\$185.00	\$105.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$250.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$550.00	\$380.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.16% today) — AI infrastructure spending is relentless, and space is now getting pulled into that gravitational orbit thanks to the Nvidia-SpaceX story.

COOLING OFF: Industrials, Materials, Utilities — classic defensive/cyclical names getting sold as capital chases growth narratives.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing out of defensives and into anything AI-adjacent. Space stocks are the newest recipients of that rotation because they now have a credible AI infrastructure story (orbital compute, satellite-based edge networks).

RELATED PLAY: If SPCX runs, the second-order winners are the launch service providers (Rocket Lab specifically) and satellite ground-station operators — plus semiconductor names selling radiation-hardened chips into space applications.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Riding launch cadence growth and Neutron rocket progress — top SPCX holding pulling the ETF up.
- IRDM (Iridium): Steady satellite comms revenue plus defense contracts — the boring cash-flow anchor of the basket.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is lagging pure-play winners like RKLB because it's a basket — you sacrifice upside for diversification. That tells me if you're truly bullish on space, individual names outperform, but SPCX is the safer way to play the theme without single-stock blowup risk.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Solid setup with narrative momentum, but the ETF structure caps upside vs. individual names.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% — Meaningful exposure without betting the farm on a still-volatile theme.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$135 or lower; the \$130 level is where the recent base formed.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with FY27 defense budget passage and continued launch cadence growth as the key catalysts.

WHEN TO BAIL: If a top-3 holding has a major operational failure, or if space appropriations get materially cut in budget negotiations, trim the position.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is to keep some cash on the side to buy pullbacks — or pair this with a short in an overvalued satellite name that's run ahead of fundamentals. Broad-market SPY puts also work if you're worried about a general tech drawdown taking the whole complex down.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Hold	\$109.76 ▲ 1.12%	12M Price Target \$118.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$98.68B
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HOOD: Retail Trading Bid Returns as Crypto Rules Loosen

WHAT HAPPENED

- HOOD ticked up 1.1% alongside Webull's 8% pop — the "retail trading bid is back" story is the theme of the day. Translation: mom-and-pop investors are trading heavily again, which is HOOD's bread and butter (they make money on every trade, especially crypto and options).
- The Coinbase/Chainlink tokenized stocks news and Coinbase's crypto-backed mortgage push tell you the crypto industry is aggressively moving into traditional finance — that's a rising tide for HOOD's crypto revenue, which was ~35% of transaction revenue last quarter.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's really going on: HOOD is trading at 51% of its 52-week range with the stock consolidating in the \$103-\$112 zone after a monster run from \$63. The options market is flashing something interesting — a bullish call/put ratio (calls outnumber puts nearly 3-to-1) BUT someone bought unusual \$170 and \$180 puts for September, which looks like big-money hedging a position they don't want to sell. That tells me institutions are still long but nervous about a pullback. The bigger picture: the Trump administration's crypto-friendly stance (CLARITY Act framework, SAB 121 repeal, pro-stablecoin GENIUS Act) has structurally re-rated crypto exchanges and brokers higher, and HOOD is one of the purest beneficiaries.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

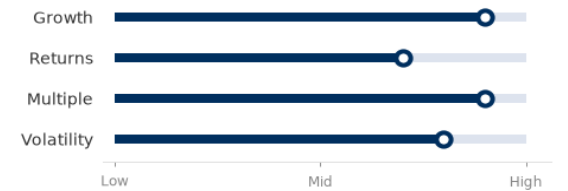
The big one to watch: the CLARITY Act (Digital Asset Market Clarity Act) and follow-on crypto market structure legislation moving through Congress — if it fully passes, it clarifies which tokens are securities vs. commodities, which is HUGE for HOOD's crypto business because it removes the SEC lawsuit overhang. Also watch the SEC's stance on prediction markets and event contracts — HOOD launched event contracts (election, sports) and a friendlier CFTC under the current administration is a direct tailwind. The one risk: if Democrats retake the House in 2026 midterms and slow-walk crypto bills, that removes a key catalyst for the stock.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

HOOD trades around 23x forward revenue and roughly 59x forward earnings — meaning investors are paying \$59 for every \$1 the company earns next year. That's expensive by any standard (Schwab trades at ~18x earnings, IBKR at ~22x), but the market is paying up because HOOD is growing revenue ~35-40% while legacy brokers grow single digits. The stock isn't cheap here — it's priced for continued crypto boom and retail engagement, so any hiccup in trading volumes gets punished hard.

Key Data	
Price (USD)	\$109.76
12M Price Target	\$118.00
Upside / (Downside)	+7.5%
Market Cap	\$98.68B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,250M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	59.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$125.00	\$112.00	\$95.00
6 Months	\$145.00	\$118.00	\$85.00
1 Year	\$170.00	\$125.00	\$75.00
2 Years	\$220.00	\$150.00	\$65.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$220.00	\$55.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$350.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+3.16% today) is roaring — AI and retail-facing fintech are getting bid as the market bets on continued deregulation and lower rates. Crypto-adjacent names are ripping on the mortgage-with-crypto and tokenization headlines.

COOLING OFF: Financials (-0.65%), Utilities, and Industrials all red — money is flowing OUT of boring dividend-payers and INTO growth/speculation, which is a classic "risk-on" tape that favors HOOD.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from defensive value into high-beta retail/crypto/AI names — the exact cocktail that benefits Robinhood's business model where more speculation = more trades = more revenue.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD's story works, look at COIN (Coinbase — pure crypto play with the tokenization catalyst), IBKR (Interactive Brokers — benefits from same retail wave with cheaper valuation), and MSTR (Bitcoin proxy that tends to move with HOOD's crypto revenue).

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- WEBULL (Webull): Up 8% today — direct competitor benefiting from same retail trading resurgence
- COIN (Coinbase): Leading crypto infrastructure with tokenized stocks on Base and crypto-backed mortgages — expanding crypto TAM

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is LAGGING today's retail-trading move (+1% vs Webull +8%), which is a slight yellow flag — could mean profit-taking after HOOD's massive year-to-date run, or it could mean HOOD's rally is more mature. Either way, it's not leading its peers today, which suggests near-term upside is capped without a fresh catalyst.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I love the business trajectory and policy tailwinds, but the stock has already run 70%+ from its 52-week low and valuation is stretched.

POSITION SIZE: 2-3% max — this is a volatile name that can drop 15% in a week; size it so a bad month doesn't ruin you.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$95-100 on any macro-driven pullback. Chasing \$110 here means you're buying near the middle of a range with limited near-term edge.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is either (a) CLARITY Act final passage or (b) HOOD's first full year of profitability at scale to justify the multiple.

WHEN TO BAIL: If monthly trading volumes drop >20% for two straight months, or if Bitcoin breaks below \$80K decisively, or if the SEC signals a PFOF ban — any of those three and I'm out.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy some September \$95 puts (cheap insurance that pays off if the stock drops 15%). Or just trim your position by a third if it hits \$130 to lock in gains.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Buy

\$571.10 ▼ 0.87%

12M Price Target
\$675.00

52-Week Range
\$520.26 – \$790.80

Market Cap
\$1.45T

META: AI Capex Story Intact, Oklo Nuclear Deal Signals Scale

WHAT HAPPENED

- Meta announced Oklo will build a 1.2-gigawatt nuclear reactor in Ohio to power its AI data centers — that's massive. For context, 1.2 GW can power roughly 900,000 homes. This tells you META is preparing for AI compute demand that dwarfs anything today, and they're locking up power supply years in advance (a huge competitive moat since power is THE bottleneck in AI right now).
- A settlement dropped on social media harm claims — this is the "new front" Reuters is flagging. Combined with the CFO and Chief Legal Officer both selling stock a week ago, it suggests management sees near-term regulatory/legal turbulence. Not a thesis-killer, but not nothing.

WHY IT MATTERS

Nothing major happened overnight — the thesis is intact. Keep an eye on price action and how the sector is moving for a potential entry point.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

See key data table.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- AI capex arms race gets out of hand — if META spends \$100B/year and the ROI doesn't show up in ad revenue within 18 months, the market will punish this like it did in late 2022 when the stock fell to \$88
- The social media harm settlement is the opening move, not the end — if enough states pile on, you could see forced product changes for teen users that hit engagement and ad targeting
- The non-obvious risk: TikTok. If the Trump administration cuts a deal that keeps TikTok fully operational in the US (looking increasingly likely), META loses the Reels tailwind that's been juicing Instagram engagement

IN THE NEWS

Why Nvidia probably just lit a new fire under these once-hot trades Yahoo Finance · 2026-08-27 10:36

Stock market today: Dow, S&P 500, Nasdaq close lower, Nvidia stock jumps after earnings Yahoo Finance · 2026-08-26 08:18

Oklo's Meta Deal Calls For a 1.2-Gigawatt Reactor in Ohio. Here's When It's Slated to Come... Motley Fool · 2026-08-27 21:55

Meta settlement opens new front in global fight over social media harm Reuters · 2026-08-27 21:33

S&P 500 investors are quietly making a huge shift TheStreet · 2026-08-27 21:17

WHAT OPTIONS TRADERS ARE DOING

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

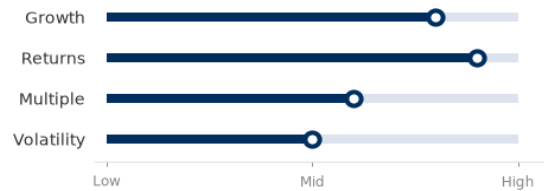
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-27 22:30 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

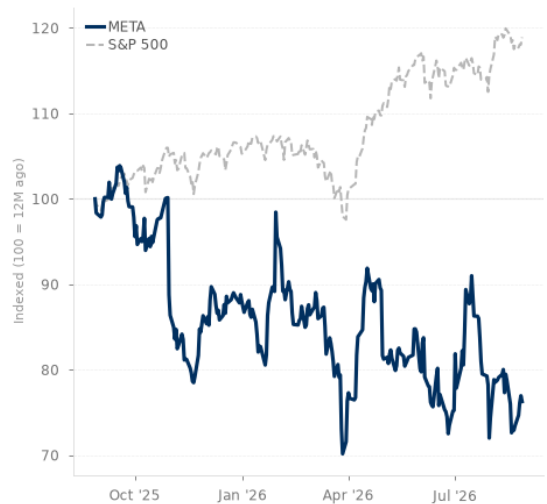
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$571.10
12M Price Target	\$675.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.2%
Market Cap	\$1.45T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$223M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	20.8x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$610.00	\$580.00	\$540.00
6 Months	\$680.00	\$620.00	\$520.00
1 Year	\$780.00	\$675.00	\$500.00
2 Years	\$900.00	\$750.00	\$480.00
5 Years	\$1200.00	\$900.00	\$450.00
10 Years	\$1800.00	\$1200.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.16% today) — Nvidia's earnings just reconfirmed that AI infrastructure spending isn't slowing down, which is a direct tailwind for anyone selling AI-powered products (META) or building the picks-and-shovels.

COOLING OFF: Energy, Utilities, Materials all red — classic "risk-on rotation into growth" tape. Money is leaving defensive/cyclical names.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flooding into AI beneficiaries, but selectively — mega-cap tech with actual AI revenue (META, MSFT, GOOGL) is where the flow is going, not speculative names. That's healthy for META.

RELATED PLAY: The Oklo deal is a tell — nuclear power companies (OKLO, CEG, VST) and data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) are the second-order winners as AI hyperscalers scramble for power.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Just posted blowout earnings — every dollar META spends on AI infrastructure flows through Nvidia first
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Similar AI ad-targeting story, but with less regulatory heat on kids' safety right now

META CONTEXT: META is LAGGING its peer group meaningfully — Tech sector is up 3% today and META is DOWN 0.87%. That's the kids' safety settlement weighing on sentiment. Historically, when META lags this badly against a strong tape, it either signals a fundamental problem OR a great buying opportunity — I lean toward the latter given valuation.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the setup but the insider selling and regulatory noise keep me from pounding the table

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% — this is a core holding, not a speculative bet, and the balance sheet gives you downside cushion

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on any pullback to \$540-560, and back up the truck if it revisits the 52-week low near \$520

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is proof that AI capex is translating into ad revenue growth (watch Q4 2026 earnings)

WHEN TO BAIL: If ad revenue growth drops below 10% year-over-year, or if a regulator forces a structural change to ad targeting, I'm gone

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — don't oversize the position. If you want protection, buy cheap out-of-the-money puts (basically insurance policies that pay off if the stock crashes) around earnings, or pair with a stable dividend name like a utility to smooth out volatility

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$935.39 ▼ 0.32%	12M Price Target \$1100.00	52-Week Range \$114.25 – \$1255.00	Market Cap N/A
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MU: Nvidia's Memory Warning Should Ignite This

WHAT HAPPENED

- Nvidia basically told the world last night that memory prices are going up and supply is tight — that's a giant flashing green light for Micron, which is one of only three companies on Earth that makes the high-bandwidth memory (HBM) that AI chips need. Weirdly, the stock BARELY moved (-0.32%) even though Barron's flagged this exact disconnect. That's either the market being slow or already having priced it in over the last few months (stock is up ~8x from the 52-week low of \$114).
- Micron announced it's DOUBLING capex (capital expenditure — money spent building factories) because the AI memory shortage is getting worse, not better. Translation: management sees demand so strong they're willing to spend billions more to catch up.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the thing that matters: when Nvidia — the customer — publicly warns about memory prices going up, that's essentially Nvidia telling investors "our suppliers have pricing power." Micron IS that supplier. This probably means the next earnings print has upside to consensus, and analysts are going to be raising price targets into that report. The options flow backs this up — a put/call ratio of 0.51 (meaning twice as many bullish bets as bearish) plus massive unusual call buying at \$915-930 strikes tells you big money is positioning for a move higher, likely before the September quarterly report. The doubled capex is a double-edged sword though: bullish because demand is real, but it also means free cash flow gets squeezed near-term as they pour money into fabs.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

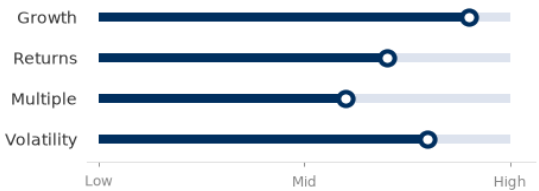
Micron is arguably the single biggest beneficiary of the CHIPS Act — they got roughly \$6.1 billion in direct federal grants to build fabs in Idaho and New York, and the Trump administration has kept the semiconductor reshoring push alive (even while renegotiating some of the terms). Watch the China tariff situation closely: the administration's export controls on advanced memory to China actually HELP Micron because they constrain Chinese competitor CXMT from catching up on HBM. If Congress moves on the pending AI infrastructure bill (still bouncing around committee), federal data center buildouts become another direct tailwind. The one risk: if Trump strikes a broader trade deal with China that loosens memory export controls, that's a headwind — but that seems unlikely near-term.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$935.39
12M Price Target	\$1100.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.6%
Market Cap	N/A
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$22.50
Fwd P/E	65.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1050.00	\$970.00	\$870.00
6 Months	\$1200.00	\$1050.00	\$800.00
1 Year	\$1400.00	\$1100.00	\$750.00
2 Years	\$1800.00	\$1300.00	\$700.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1600.00	\$600.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2200.00	\$500.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors (+3.16% today) — the whole complex just got a shot of adrenaline from Nvidia's commentary. AI infrastructure names broadly benefit from tight supply signals because it validates that demand is outrunning capacity.

COOLING OFF: Energy, Utilities, Industrials all red — classic defensive/old-economy rotation OUT as money chases AI momentum again. Financials also weak, which suggests risk-on tech trade not a broad market rally.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is clearly rotating INTO AI semis and OUT of defensives today. When you see tech +3% while everything else is red, that's a concentrated bet — powerful in the short term but makes the trade crowded.

RELATED PLAY: If Micron's HBM story is real, the equipment makers who sell to Micron benefit too — Applied Materials (AMAT), Lam Research (LRCX), and ASML all get orders when Micron doubles capex. Those are second-derivative plays.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the tip of the AI spear — their commentary literally moves the whole memory/semi supply chain
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI chip business is quietly compounding, benefits from the same hyperscaler capex wave

MU CONTEXT: Micron is LAGGING today despite arguably having the most direct benefit from Nvidia's comments — the Barron's headline literally said "Stock Hasn't Budged." That's usually a setup for catch-up trade in coming days. When a stock underreacts to obviously bullish news, it either means the market doesn't believe it yet (opportunity) or knows something we don't (risk). I lean toward opportunity here given the options flow.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$900-920 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM pricing rolls over or Samsung/SK Hynix flood supply faster than expected

Hedging: Pair with short position in a lagging DRAM name or buy protective puts on SMH

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold	\$354.81 ▲ 2.60%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83	Market Cap \$1.40T
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TSLA: Bouncing Back on Tech Rally, Optimus Story Building

WHAT HAPPENED

- TSLA popped 2.6% today, mostly riding the Tech sector rally (+3.16%) — this looks more like "money rotating into tech beta" than anything Tesla-specific. When Tech ETFs rip, TSLA usually rips harder because it's a high-volatility momentum name.
- The Optimus robot narrative is getting louder — Simply Wall St piece on Optimus + Starbase, plus news that competitor 1X (backed by OpenAI/SoftBank) could be worth \$6B. That's actually bullish for TSLA's Optimus valuation-by-comparison, but it also signals real competition is coming.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what to really chew on: TSLA is trading at only 29% of its 52-week range (\$297-\$499), meaning it's closer to the low than the high — the stock has been quietly underperforming despite the AI hype. That tells me investors are wrestling with the core auto business slowing (Ford comparison articles are a tell — nobody compares winners to laggards) while trying to underwrite Optimus and robotaxi as the next leg. The unusual call buying at \$350-355 strikes expiring THIS week suggests traders are betting on a short-term squeeze, not a fundamental re-rating — that's momentum trading, not conviction. Bigger picture: the EV tax credit sunset under the current administration and looming tariff/China risk means Tesla NEEDS the AI story to work, because the auto growth engine is stalling.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The biggest overhang: the \$7,500 federal EV tax credit was gutted in the 2025 reconciliation bill and fully expired for most buyers — that's a direct demand headwind hitting TSLA's US auto business right now. On the flip side, the administration's push on autonomous vehicle federal preemption (overriding state-by-state robotaxi rules) would be a massive tailwind if it advances — TSLA needs one federal standard, not 50 different ones, to scale Cybercab. Watch the NHTSA autonomous vehicle framework updates expected this fall, and any China tariff escalation, since TSLA's Shanghai gigafactory is exposed both ways (exports out, components in).

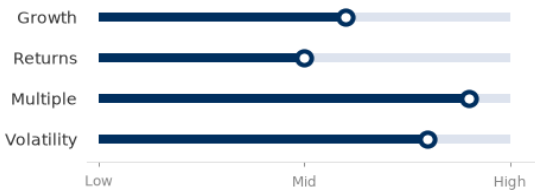
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~165x forward earnings, investors are paying \$165 for every \$1 of profit Tesla will make next year — compare that to Ford at ~7x or even Nvidia at ~35x. You're not buying a car company at this price; you're buying a bet that Optimus and robotaxi become real businesses. The math only works if you believe robotaxi hits scale by 2027 and Optimus becomes a legit revenue line — otherwise this is a \$200 stock wearing a \$355 costume.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$354.81
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+8.5%
Market Cap	\$1.40T
FY2026E Revenue	\$108M
FY2027E Revenue	\$132M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.40
Fwd P/E	165.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$385.00	\$360.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$450.00	\$375.00	\$290.00
1 Year	\$500.00	\$385.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$650.00	\$425.00	\$230.00
5 Years	\$900.00	\$500.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$1500.00	\$700.00	\$180.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.16%) — the AI capex cycle is still the dominant flow, and any dovish Fed signal amplifies it. TSLA rides this wave as an "AI-adjacent" name.

COOLING OFF: Industrials, Materials, Utilities all red — classic "risk-on rotation OUT of defensives INTO growth/tech" day. Energy is weak too, which usually correlates with EV positive sentiment.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing from cyclical/defensives into mega-cap tech — that's why TSLA outperformed today. This rotation continues as long as rates stay stable and AI earnings keep beating.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the Optimus/humanoid robot thesis but don't want TSLA valuation risk, look at the supply chain — NVDA (chips for robot brains) and the industrial automation names benefit regardless of which robot maker wins.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the purest AI infrastructure play — every robot, every autonomous car, every AI model runs on their chips
- PLTR (Palantir): AI software winner riding federal contracts and enterprise adoption

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is LAGGING its Mag-7 peers badly — sitting at 29% of its 52-week range while NVDA and others are near highs. That means the market is either giving you a bargain on a temporarily out-of-favor name, OR it's telling you something's genuinely broken with the auto core. I lean toward the latter until robotaxi delivers.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — cautiously neutral; too expensive to pound the table, too story-rich to short

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% max — this is a volatile name where a bad Elon tweet or missed delivery number can drop 10% overnight

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for \$310-330 on a broader market pullback — you're getting more margin of safety and the technical setup is better near 52-week lows

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalysts I'm waiting for are meaningful robotaxi city expansions and the first Optimus commercial deployment numbers

WHEN TO BAIL: If auto deliveries drop >15% YoY without offsetting AI/robotics revenue, or if robotaxi rollout gets pushed to 2028, the thesis breaks

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — pair a TSLA position with a legacy automaker like Ford; if EVs disappoint, Ford wins on relative basis. Or buy a put option 10% below current price as cheap insurance against a earnings-driven selloff

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$227.98 ▲ 8.74%	12M Price Target \$275.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.52T
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NVDA: Blowout Quarter Silences Bears, China Still Wildcard

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA ripped +8.7% on nearly 300M shares (2x normal volume) after last night's earnings — this was a "silence the bears" print. Data center revenue blew past estimates and guidance was raised, which matters because the whole bear case was "AI capex is peaking." It's clearly not.
- China remains the ugly asterisk. Management basically said they're planning without meaningful China revenue in the near term — the fact that the stock ripped anyway tells you the market is now valuing NVDA on the rest of the world alone.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's the big inference: when a \$5T company gaps up 9% on 2x volume after earnings, that's institutions who were underweight scrambling to catch up — not retail chasing. The dividend chatter in the news flow is also meaningful; when a hyper-growth name starts getting compared to Apple's dividend era, it signals the market is starting to treat NVDA as a mature cash-flow monster rather than a speculative growth stock, which usually supports a higher, more stable multiple. The Jensen "ecosystem that can't fail" narrative is doing real work — CUDA + Blackwell + networking (Mellanox) + robotics (Omniverse) means competitors like AMD have to beat NVDA on four fronts simultaneously, and they're not. Watch for: hyperscaler capex guidance from MSFT/META/GOOGL next quarter — if they raise again, NVDA has another leg up regardless of what China does.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

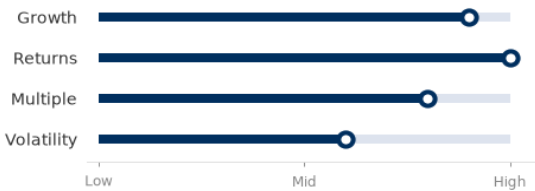
The single biggest policy variable is the China export control regime — the Trump administration has been running a hot/cold dance where NVDA gets partial licenses for H20 chips in exchange for a revenue-share arrangement with Treasury (unprecedented, and legally shaky). If that framework holds or expands to Blackwell-derivatives, that's billions in optionality the Street isn't fully modeling. On the tailwind side, the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and the AI infrastructure buildout language in the current appropriations cycle explicitly favor domestic AI compute — NVDA is the de facto beneficiary of any federal AI spending, including the ~\$40B in AI-related DoD and DOE budget lines being debated. Watch the Commerce Department's next export control update in September; that's the near-term binary.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$227.98
12M Price Target	\$275.00
Upside / (Downside)	+20.6%
Market Cap	\$5.52T
FY2026E Revenue	\$215M
FY2027E Revenue	\$285M
FY2026E EPS	\$4.85
FY2027E EPS	\$6.60
Fwd P/E	47.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$245.00	\$232.00	\$210.00
6 Months	\$275.00	\$250.00	\$195.00
1 Year	\$310.00	\$275.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$330.00	\$175.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$250.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Technology (+3.16% today) is being led entirely by AI-infrastructure names — semis, hyperscalers, and power/cooling suppliers. The tailwind is federal AI spending priorities plus corporate FOMO on generative AI.

COOLING OFF: Energy, Utilities, Industrials all red — classic risk-on rotation OUT of defensives INTO growth. Utilities weakness is ironic given AI power demand, but rates are the driver here.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing from defensive/value into AI-levered tech after NVDA's print gave the whole complex a green light. This is a "confirmation" trade — funds that were skeptical are now forced to add.

RELATED PLAY: The AI power/cooling supply chain (VRT for cooling, ETN for electrical, CEG for nuclear power PPAs to data centers) benefits directly when NVDA guides up — those companies literally can't ship product fast enough.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon for hyperscalers — the "if not NVDA, then AVGO" trade. Riding the same wave.
- VRT (Vertiv): Data center cooling — every Blackwell rack needs liquid cooling, and Vertiv basically owns that market.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is LEADING the AI complex today, not lagging, which matters — when the group leader gaps up on earnings and holds it, the sector usually grinds higher for weeks as underweight funds catch up. If NVDA were up 9% but AVGO/AMD were flat, I'd worry it was a short-covering pop; the fact that the whole complex is green confirms this is real re-rating, not a squeeze.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 5-8% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$210-215 on macro pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Data center revenue growth drops below 25% YoY or China H20/B-series export ban becomes permanent with no workaround

Hedging: Long-dated puts or pair with a short on a smaller AI-hardware name at richer multiple (e.g., ARM)

Alphabet Inc.
GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	\$340.65 ▼ 0.39%	12M Price Target \$385.00	52-Week Range \$206.20 – \$408.61	Market Cap \$4.17T
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GOOGL: Cooling Off After Rally, But AI Tailwinds Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- GOOGL slipped 0.4% to \$340.65, extending a 4-day pullback from \$348 — but read this in context: Tech sector is up 3.16% today, so GOOGL is LAGGING. Money rotated hard into Nvidia/semis after NVDA's blowout \$96B quarter and Marvell's data center surge, and traders are trimming the "already-won" mega-caps to chase the semi trade.
- Anthropic reportedly walked away from a \$7B acquisition of custom-chip startup MatX — matters for GOOGL because it signals AI labs are still scrambling for compute, which validates Google's TPU (their in-house AI chip) advantage as a structural moat.

WHY IT MATTERS

The mild sell-off isn't a GOOGL problem — it's a rotation problem. When semis rip, hyperscalers (the big cloud buyers like Google, Amazon, Microsoft) often get sold as "who's paying for all this capex" fears creep in. But here's the inference: massively bullish options flow (put/call ratio of 0.47, meaning traders are buying nearly 3 calls for every put) plus unusual call activity at \$340-342.50 strikes tells me smart money is positioning for a bounce, not a breakdown. The insider "selling" is Sergey Brin's pre-planned 10b5-1 distributions — noise, not signal. Bottom line: this is consolidation after a huge run from \$206 to \$408, and the setup into Q3 earnings looks constructive.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one: the DOJ antitrust remedy phase in the Search monopoly case is the overhang everyone's watching. Under the current administration, the tone has softened from "break up Google" toward behavioral remedies (like default search deal restrictions) — that's a huge de-risking event if it lands that way this fall. Also watch the CHIPS Act 2.0 chatter and the AI executive order framework: Google's TPU manufacturing partnerships and domestic data center buildouts position them to capture federal AI infrastructure dollars, while the EU's Digital Markets Act continues to be the bigger ongoing headwind (roughly 8% of ad revenue exposure).

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$340, GOOGL trades around 34x forward earnings — meaning you're paying \$34 for every \$1 of profit they'll make next year. That's a premium to the S&P 500 (~22x) but a DISCOUNT to Microsoft (~37x) and Meta (~28x adjusted for growth), which is nuts given Google Cloud is growing 30%+ and Gemini is finally showing traction. Translation: you're getting the AI upside for cheaper than peers because the market is still discounting antitrust risk — that's the opportunity.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

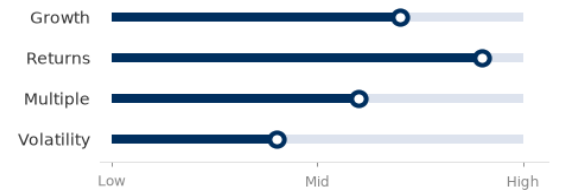
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-27 22:30 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$340.65
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+13.0%
Market Cap	\$4.17T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$468M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	34.6x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$360.00	\$345.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$375.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$440.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$520.00	\$430.00	\$275.00
5 Years	\$750.00	\$580.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$850.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors and AI infrastructure — NVDA's \$96B print and Marvell's data center strength confirm the capex cycle is still accelerating. Tech broadly is +3% today on the AI enthusiasm.

COOLING OFF: Defensives (Utilities -0.76%, Industrials -0.85%) as risk-on rotation pulls money out of safety trades. Energy weakening on demand concerns.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing from mega-cap hyperscalers INTO the chip suppliers this week — classic "picks and shovels" trade. This usually reverses within 2-4 weeks as investors realize the hyperscalers are the ones actually printing the money.

RELATED PLAY: If you want the second-order bet, data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) and power infrastructure (VRT, GEV) benefit from the same AI buildout GOOGL is funding.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Q2 beat plus strong Q3 guide reinforces they're still the toll-collector on AI compute.
- MRVL (Marvell): Data center revenue surge shows custom silicon demand (relevant because GOOGL's TPU is the same trade internally).

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL is lagging the tech tape today, which is actually the setup I like — it means the stock hasn't gotten ahead of itself, and any positive antitrust headline or strong Cloud print becomes an asymmetric catalyst. Laggards in a strong sector often become the next leaders.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — This is one of the highest-quality risk/reward setups in mega-cap tech; the antitrust discount is the gift.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a surprise DOJ headline doesn't wreck you.

ENTRY POINTS: Add on pullbacks to \$325-335 (roughly the 50-day moving average zone). Today's \$340 is fine for starters but not a fat pitch.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — main catalysts are the DOJ remedy ruling this fall and Q3/Q4 Cloud growth prints.

WHEN TO BAIL: Search ad revenue declines 2 quarters in a row, forced structural divestiture, or Cloud growth drops below 20%.

HEDGING: If you're nervous about antitrust headline risk, buy a cheap 6-month put 10% below the current price — think of it as insurance that costs ~2% of your position for peace of mind.

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$241.45 ▼ 1.49%	12M Price Target \$285.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$216.99B
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MRVL: Solid Earnings, But Expectations Bar Just Got Higher

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL reported strong earnings AND guided higher — but the stock still slid after hours. Classic "buy the rumor, sell the news" — expectations were so hot going in (stock had run from \$61 to \$329 in a year) that "solid beat" wasn't enough. The market wanted a blowout.
- Options flow is actually bullish (put/call at 0.61, meaning way more call bets than puts), but big block puts at \$230 tell me some funds are buying insurance while staying long — hedging, not fleeing.

WHY IT MATTERS

This is a "quality of the reaction" moment — the fact that MRVL sold off on good news tells you the stock is priced for perfection, but the fundamentals underneath are still intact. That's actually healthy: it flushes out weak hands and resets the bar. The bigger tell is that Tech ETFs ripped +3.16% today while MRVL bled — meaning money is chasing AI winners like NVDA but pausing on MRVL specifically until the next catalyst (likely more custom silicon wins from Amazon or Microsoft). Watch the \$230 level — if it holds, this is just a pause before the next leg; if it breaks, we're looking at a deeper unwind toward \$215.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The CHIPS Act reauthorization debate and expanded semiconductor tax credits are the big tailwind — MRVL benefits directly from domestic fab incentives since they're a fabless designer partnering with TSMC's Arizona facility. On the flip side, watch the Commerce Department's ongoing tightening of AI chip export controls to China — MRVL has meaningful China exposure (~15% of revenue historically), so any escalation is a direct headwind, but it also locks Chinese competitors out of the US hyperscaler market where MRVL dominates. Net-net, the regulatory environment is a moat-builder for them, not a threat.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

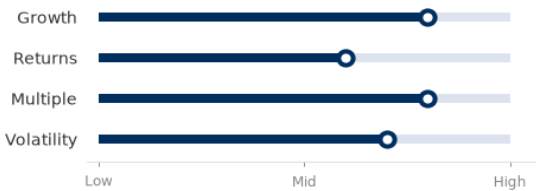
At ~\$217B market cap on forward earnings, you're paying roughly \$85 for every \$1 of next year's profit — that's expensive by any traditional measure, but AI infrastructure names trade like this because growth is compounding at 40%+. Compared to NVDA (~35x forward) MRVL looks pricier on earnings, but cheaper on revenue growth relative to its custom ASIC pipeline. The valuation is justified ONLY if hyperscaler capex keeps climbing — the moment that slows, this multiple gets cut in half fast.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$241.45
12M Price Target	\$285.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.0%
Market Cap	\$216.99B
FY2027E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2028E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2027E EPS	\$2.85
FY2028E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	84.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$265.00	\$245.00	\$215.00
6 Months	\$300.00	\$265.00	\$200.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$285.00	\$190.00
2 Years	\$420.00	\$340.00	\$210.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$450.00	\$250.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$650.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Tech (+3.16% today) is on fire — AI infrastructure spending is the market's favorite trade, and dovish Fed expectations from Jackson Hole are fueling the rotation into growth.

COOLING OFF: Energy, Utilities, Industrials all red — defensive and cyclical money is rotating out as risk-on sentiment takes over.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is flowing hard into AI semis and away from anything rate-sensitive or defensive — the market is betting on rate cuts + continued capex boom, which is the perfect cocktail for MRVL's sector.

RELATED PLAY: If custom AI silicon keeps winning, watch AVGO (Broadcom) — same custom ASIC playbook — and data center power/cooling names like VRT (Vertiv), which benefit from every chip MRVL ships.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Jumped today, still the AI infrastructure king — anytime Nvidia rips, MRVL usually follows within days.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Direct custom silicon competitor benefiting from the same hyperscaler capex wave.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is LAGGING today — Tech ETF up 3%, MRVL down 1.5%. That's a red flag short-term but a green flag if you're looking to add: the sector is validating the AI thesis, MRVL just had its "expectations reset" moment, and mean reversion typically follows.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Cautiously bullish. The story is intact, but the post-earnings dip tells me to be patient on entry rather than chase.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — real upside but real volatility (52-week range is \$61 to \$329, that's insane).

ENTRY POINTS: \$225-235 on pullbacks. If it breaks \$220, wait for it to stabilize before adding — don't catch a falling knife.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst I'm waiting for is the next custom silicon contract announcement plus confirmation that hyperscaler capex accelerates into 2027.

WHEN TO BAIL: If they lose the Amazon Trainium relationship, if data center revenue growth drops below 40% YoY, or if the stock breaks \$200 on heavy volume.

HEDGING: Buy some cheap protective puts on the SMH semiconductor ETF — that way if the whole sector rolls over, you're covered without giving up your MRVL upside.

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	8.9/10	BUY
Price: \$38.46 · 1M: +35.2% · P/S: 0.6x · Cap: \$24.9B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
2	GTLB	GitLab Inc. AI & Machine Learning	8.6/10	BUY
Price: \$44.81 · 1M: +35.9% · P/S: 7.5x · Cap: \$7.6B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
3	LDOS	Leidos Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	8.5/10	BUY
Price: \$139.86 · 1M: +18.2% · P/S: 1.0x · Cap: \$17.6B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
4	RCAT	Red Cat Holdings, Inc. Defense Technology	7.9/10	WATCH
Price: \$9.28 · 1M: +24.6% · P/S: 19.8x · Cap: \$1.4B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$12 entry				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
5	LRCX	Lam Research Corporation Semiconductors	7.9/10	BUY
Price: \$318.58 · 1M: +18.2% · P/S: 17.2x · Cap: \$398.6B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	